MARIO: THE CYBER HEIST

CLASSIFICATION: **EYES ONLY**
THREAT LEVEL: OMEGA

CHANAKYA UNIVERSITY • OJAS TECH FEST 2026 • OFFICIAL CTF PARTICIPANT GUIDE

■ INCIDENT BRIEFING — OPERATION: RECOVER THE GOLDEN STAR
At **03:14:07 AM**, the Mushroom Kingdom Master Sanctum vault security perimeter collapsed. The kingdom's core power source, **THE GOLDEN STAR**, was exfiltrated by rogue cyber syndicate **'PHANTOM_SHROOM'**. As cyber operatives, your mission is to investigate compromised sectors on the **3D World Map**, analyze forensic evidence, bypass firewalls, defeat Bowser's mainframe shields, and recover the Golden Star.

■■ 1. SECTOR PROGRESSION & FORENSIC WORKBENCHES

SEC	SECTOR NAME	FORENSIC SPECIALIZATION & OBJECTIVES	GATING STATUS
01	**Mushroom Village**	Exif metadata extraction, Wireshark PCAP packet analysis, Linux file permissions & SUID escalation.	**0 ■ Unlocked**
02	**Dark Forest**	SQL Injection auth bypass, SHA-256 rainbow tables / password cracking, DOM XSS payload sanitization.	**2 ■ Required**
03	**Haunted Mansion**	Python bytecode decompilation, memory buffer overflow analysis, encrypted firmware string extraction.	**5 ■ Required**
04	**Koopa HQ**	JWT secret key forgery / privilege escalation, Insecure AWS S3 cloud bucket enumeration.	**8 ■ Required**
05	**Final Fortress**	**Three-Stage Boss Showdown:** Phase 1 (4 Sector Shields) → Phase 2 (Cyber Trivia) → Phase 3 (Master Flag).	**11 ■ Required**

■ 2. SCORING SYSTEM & GAME ECONOMY

■ Forensic Points (Score)
Every case cleared awards between **100 to 500 PTS** based on forensic complexity. Scores are registered atomically on the official server ledger.

■ Golden Stars (0 - 12)
Cases 1–11 award 1 Star each. Accumulate stars to dissolve quantum firewalls guarding higher sector islands. Clearing all 11 unlocks Bowser's Fortress.

■ Cyber Coins & 3D ? Blocks
Each squad starts with **100 Cyber Coins**. Earn more by solving cases or clicking floating 3D Question Blocks on the map. Spend coins to decrypt hints!

■■ Monotonic Competition Timer
High-precision competition clock calibrated with server UTC. Automatically locks the exact millisecond the final Boss flag is verified.

■ 3. MULTI-MEMBER SQUAD COLLABORATION

- **Squad Access Codes:** The team leader registers the squad name and receives a unique cryptographic access code (e.g., CYBER-W7KP-92RM).
- **Simultaneous Device Access:** Teammates join from their own laptops by entering the Access Code and their operative handle.
- **Live State Synchronization:** Solved flags, recovered stars, coin balance, and unlocked hints update in real time across all squad members.

MARIO: THE CYBER HEIST

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT RULES & CODE OF CONDUCT • REGULATION ID: CTF-REG-2026

■ 4. OFFICIAL COMPETITION REGULATIONS

1. Standard Flag Format: All flags strictly adhere to the standardized structure: FLAG{SAMPLE_FLAG_TEXT}. Flags are strictly **case-sensitive** and must include the outer FLAG{...} wrapper.

2. Anti-Brute-Force Rate Limiting: Automated dictionary attacks, fuzzing, or rapid scripted submissions against the flag submission box trigger automatic IP and squad rate limiting (**maximum 10 attempts per 30 seconds**).

3. Hint Transparency Policy: Unlocking forensic hints deducts Cyber Coins permanently from your team's treasury. Hints are progressive (Tier 1: Investigative Angle → Tier 2: Specific Vector).

4. Deterministic Podium Tie-Breaking: Standings are ranked automatically without arbitrary manual overrides using this strict priority cascade:

1. **Total Forensic Points (Score)** — *Highest score ranks first*
2. **Normal Golden Stars Recovered** — *Most cases cleared ranks higher*
3. **Mission Completion Status** — *Squads that breached the Boss Fortress rank above active squads*
4. **Total Elapsed Mission Time** — *Faster completion clock ranks higher*
5. **Timestamp of Final Solved Flag** — *Earlier server-recorded solve timestamp breaks final ties*

■■ PROHIBITED ACTIONS (ZERO TOLERANCE — IMMEDIATE DISQUALIFICATION)

- **Infrastructure Attacks:** Do NOT launch Denial-of-Service (DoS/DDoS) floods, SQL injection against platform endpoints, or port scans against the host server. All challenge exploitation is strictly confined to individual case workbenches.
- **Inter-Squad Collusion:** Sharing flags, private keys, solutions, or access codes with competing squads is strictly prohibited.
- **Account Hijacking:** Do NOT attempt to brute-force or use another team's Access Code or session credentials.

■ 5. OPERATIVE QUICKSTART CHECKLIST

- ■ **Step 1 — Register Squad:** Open the tournament portal and click **'REGISTER SQUAD'**. Enter your team name.
- ■ **Step 2 — Distribute Access Code:** Copy your squad's cryptographic Access Code and share it with your teammates.
- ■ **Step 3 — Inspect 3D Map:** Review the Mission Briefing and begin investigation in Sector 01 (Mushroom Village).
- ■ **Step 4 — Breach Bowser's Fortress:** Accumulate 11 Golden Stars to unlock Sector 05 and defeat the final boss!

TOURNAMENT AUTHORIZATION:
OJAS 2026 ORGANIZING COMMITTEE
Chanakya University Cyber Security Directorate • Bangalore, India

STATUS: VERIFIED & ACTIVE
OFFICIAL COMPETITION BRIEFING
Chanakya University Tech Fest